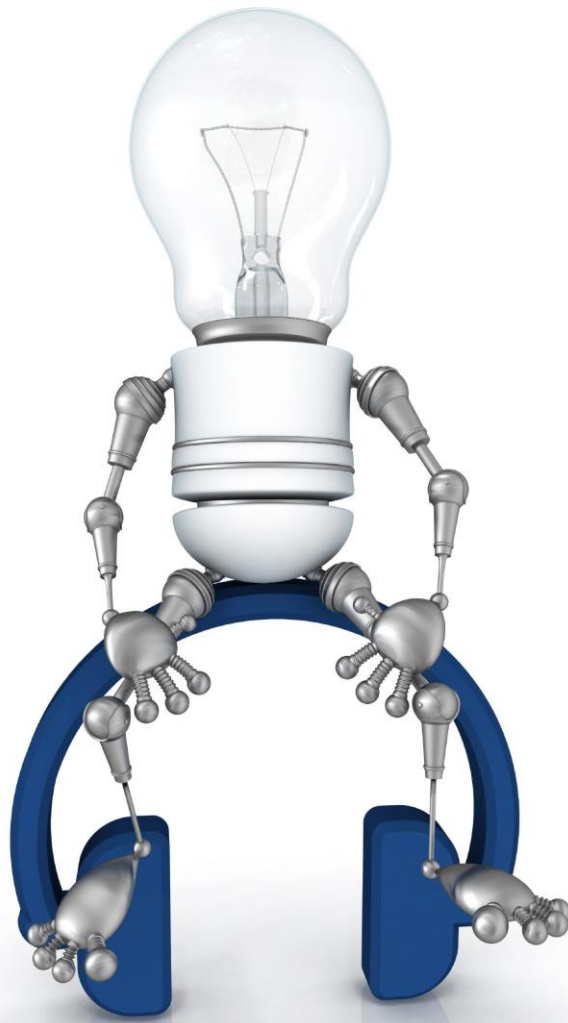




Assessing your Listening Skills

Ei4Change

Assessing your Listening Skills

Assessing your Listening

Tick the box that describes you as a listener

Superior

☐

Excellent

☐

Above average

☐

Good

☐

Average

☐

Below average

☐

Poor

☐

Terrible

☐

Assessing your Listening Skills

How do you think the following people would rate you as a listener on scale of 0 to 100? (0 being terrible, 100 being superior)

Your partner

Your best friend

Your manager

A business colleague (internal)

A business colleague (external)

Someone who reports to you

Assessing your Listening Skills

85% of people rate themselves as average or less. Fewer than 5% rate themselves as excellent or superior (and they are probably not!).

When comparing the listening self-ratings and projected ratings of others, most respondents believe that their best friend would rate them highest as a listener. This rating is likely to be higher than the how they rated themselves - where the average was a 55. This is most likely because being a best friend is such an intimate, special kind of relationship that you can't imagine it ever existing unless you were a good listener. If you didn't listen, you wouldn't be best friends to begin with.

Going down the list, people usually think their managers would rate them higher than they rated themselves. Part of that is probably wishful thinking and part of it is true. (We do tend to listen to our managers better - whether it's out of respect or fear or whatever reason doesn't matter.)

The scores for colleague and subordinate work out to be just about the same as the listener rated themselves, about 55 again!

When we consider the scores for our partner, something dramatic happens. The score here is significantly lower than that 55 average. What is interesting is that the figure gets less over time. Newlyweds tend to rate their spouse at the same high level as their best friend. As the marriage goes on (and on) the rating falls. So, in a household where the couple has been married 50+ years, there could be a lot of talk, but is anyone really listening?

Assessing your Listening Skills



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